

UI/UX Design Internship – CodeAlpha

UX Case Study: Wallet by BudgetBakers

Introduction

Wallet by BudgetBakers is a personal finance management application designed to help users effectively manage their daily income, expenses, budgets, and savings. The app provides a comprehensive platform where users can record financial transactions, categorize expenses, monitor spending patterns, and generate detailed financial reports. With features such as budget planning, multiple account management, cloud synchronization, and interactive analytics, the application enables users to gain better control over their personal finances and make informed financial decisions.

In today's digital era, personal finance management has become an essential part of everyday life due to the increasing use of digital payments, online banking, and cashless transactions. Managing finances manually can be time-consuming and prone to errors, making expense tracking applications increasingly valuable. An effective finance application should not only provide powerful features but also offer an intuitive, user-friendly interface that allows users to quickly record transactions, monitor budgets, and access financial insights with minimal effort.

This UX case study aims to evaluate the overall user experience of Wallet by BudgetBakers by analyzing its user journey, identifying its key strengths and usability challenges, and proposing practical design improvements. The evaluation focuses on important UX principles such as usability, consistency, accessibility, visual hierarchy, and ease of navigation. Through this analysis, the case study demonstrates how thoughtful design enhancements can simplify financial management, reduce user effort, improve engagement, and create a more seamless and satisfying experience for both new and existing users.

Objective

The objective of this case study is to analyze the user experience of Wallet by BudgetBakers by evaluating its user journey, identifying its strengths and weaknesses, and proposing design improvements that enhance usability, efficiency, and overall user satisfaction while maintaining the application's core functionality.

Target Users

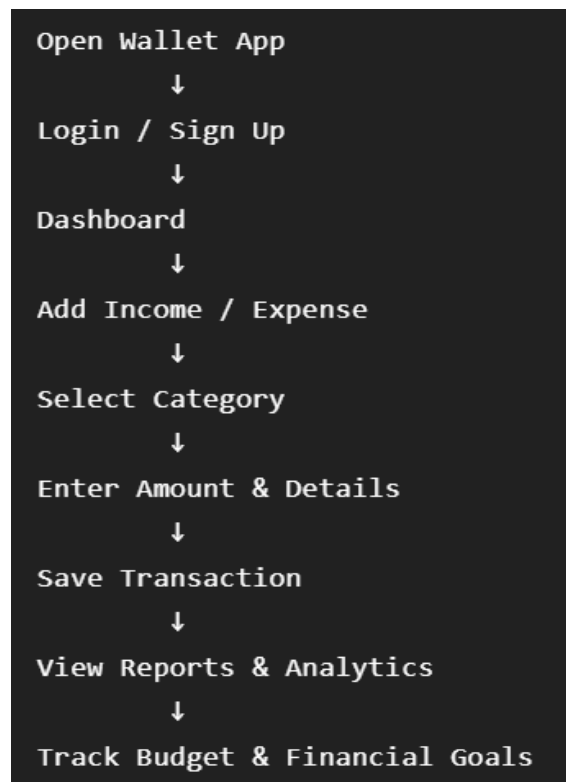
- Students managing daily expenses

- Working professionals
- Freelancers
- Families managing household budgets
- Small business owners
- Individuals who want to track their income, expenses, budgets, and savings efficiently

User Journey

The user journey represents the complete experience a user goes through while interacting with the Wallet by BudgetBakers application. From opening the app to tracking financial reports, each step is designed to help users efficiently manage their personal finances. Understanding this journey helps identify areas where the application performs well and where improvements can enhance the overall user experience.

User Flow



Step by Step User Journey

1. Open the Application

The user launches the Wallet by BudgetBakers application from their mobile device. The splash screen appears, followed by the login screen or dashboard if the user is already authenticated.

2. Login / Sign Up

New users create an account using their email, Google account, or other available methods, while existing users log in to access their saved financial data securely.

3. Dashboard

After logging in, users arrive at the dashboard, where they can view their account balance, recent transactions, budgets, spending summaries, and financial insights. This serves as the main hub for managing personal finances.

4. Add Income or Expense

Users can quickly record a new transaction by selecting whether it is an income or an expense. They enter the amount, choose the appropriate category, add optional notes, and specify the transaction date.

5. Save Transaction

Once all required information is entered, the user saves the transaction. The application immediately updates the account balance, recent transaction list, and financial summaries.

6. View Reports and Analytics

Users can explore charts, graphs, and detailed reports that display spending habits, income trends, category-wise expenses, and monthly financial summaries. These insights help users understand where their money is being spent.

7. Monitor Budget and Financial Goals

Finally, users track their budgets and financial goals using the budgeting tools provided by the application. This helps them monitor spending limits, identify overspending, and improve financial planning over time.

Strengths

1. Clean and Modern User Interface

Wallet by BudgetBakers features a visually appealing and organized interface. The use of clear typography, consistent colors, and intuitive icons makes the application easy to navigate for most users.

2. Comprehensive Expense Management

The application allows users to record both income and expenses with detailed categorization. This helps users maintain accurate financial records and better understand their spending habits.

3. Budget Planning and Financial Goals

Users can create budgets and monitor their spending against predefined limits. This feature encourages better financial discipline and helps users achieve their savings goals.

4. Interactive Reports and Analytics

The app provides charts and graphical reports that allow users to analyze spending patterns, income trends, and category-wise expenses, making financial data easier to understand.

5. Multi-Account Support

Wallet supports multiple accounts, including bank accounts, cash wallets, and credit cards, enabling users to manage all their finances from a single application.

6. Cloud Synchronization

The cloud backup feature ensures that users can securely access their financial information across multiple devices without losing data.

Weakness

1. Information Overload on Dashboard

The dashboard displays several widgets and financial details simultaneously, which may feel overwhelming for new users and reduce readability.

2. Expense Entry Requires Multiple Steps

Adding an expense involves navigating through several screens before saving the transaction. Frequent users may find this process time-consuming.

3. Complex Financial Reports

Although the reports provide detailed insights, the large amount of information displayed can make it difficult for users to quickly interpret important financial trends.

4. Navigation Can Be Improved

Some important features, such as budgets and reports, require multiple taps to access. A simpler navigation structure could improve efficiency.

5. Limited Dashboard Customization

Users have limited control over rearranging or hiding dashboard widgets. Allowing dashboard personalization would improve usability for different user preferences.

Summary

Wallet by BudgetBakers provides a feature-rich and reliable expense management experience with excellent budgeting and reporting capabilities. However, simplifying the dashboard, reducing the number of steps required for common tasks, and improving navigation could significantly enhance the overall user experience. Addressing these usability challenges would make the application more accessible, efficient, and enjoyable for both new and experienced users.

Suggested Improvements

Improvement 1: Simplified Dashboard

Problem

The current dashboard displays multiple widgets, charts, and financial information simultaneously. While the information is valuable, it can feel overwhelming for new users and makes it difficult to quickly identify the most important details.

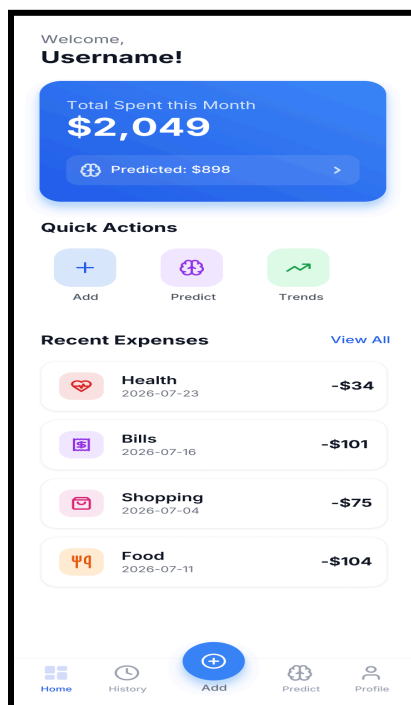
Proposed Solution

Redesign the dashboard with a cleaner layout that prioritizes essential information such as the total balance, monthly spending, and recent transactions. Allow users to customize the dashboard by choosing which widgets they want to display.

Expected Benefits

- Improved readability
- Reduced cognitive load
- Faster access to important financial information
- Better user personalization

Mockup



Improvement 2: Quick Expense Entry

Problem

Recording an expense requires multiple steps, including selecting categories and entering transaction details. Users who frequently record expenses may find this process repetitive and time-consuming.

Proposed Solution

Introduce a Floating Action Button (FAB) that opens a quick expense entry panel. Display frequently used categories, auto-fill the current date, and suggest recently used categories to reduce user effort.

Expected Benefits

- Faster expense recording
- Fewer user interactions
- Increased efficiency
- Better overall user experience

Mockup

The mockup displays a mobile application interface for adding an expense. At the top, there is a back arrow and the title "Add Expense". Below this, the "Amount" field is set to "0.00". The "Category" field is set to "Food" with a "Change" link. The "Date" field is set to "2026-07-21" with a "Change" link. The "Notes" field is labeled "Add notes..." with an "Edit" link. A large blue "Save Expense" button is positioned below the form fields. At the bottom, a navigation bar contains five icons: Home, History, Add (highlighted with a blue circle and plus sign), Predict, and Profile.

Improvement 3: Improved Transaction History

Problem

The existing category selection process can become time-consuming, especially for users who record multiple transactions every day. Users need to scroll through several categories to find the appropriate one, which increases the effort required to add an expense. The lack of clear visual distinction between categories may also slow down the selection process.

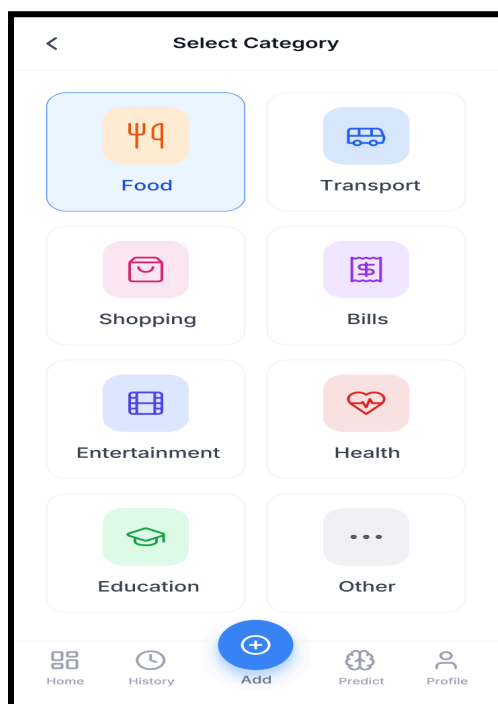
Proposed Solution

Redesign the category selection screen using a clean grid layout with colorful icons, larger touch targets, and a clearly highlighted selected category. Frequently used categories can also be displayed at the top to reduce the time required for selecting an expense category.

Expected Benefits

- Faster category selection
- Reduced user effort
- Improved accessibility with larger touch targets
- Better visual organization using icons and colors
- Enhanced overall user experience

Mockup:



Conclusion

Conclusion

Wallet by BudgetBakers is a powerful and feature-rich personal finance management application that helps users efficiently track income, expenses, budgets, and savings. Its clean interface, comprehensive financial tools, and detailed analytics make it a valuable solution for individuals looking to manage their finances effectively. The application successfully provides essential features such as expense tracking, budget planning, multiple account management, and financial reporting, making it suitable for a wide range of users.

However, this case study identified several opportunities to further enhance the user experience. Simplifying the dashboard can reduce information overload and improve readability, while introducing a quicker expense entry process can help users complete common tasks more efficiently. Additionally, redesigning the category selection interface with better visual organization and frequently used categories can make recording transactions faster and more intuitive.

Implementing these improvements would create a more user-friendly and engaging experience by reducing cognitive load, improving navigation efficiency, and making financial management simpler for both new and experienced users. Overall, Wallet by BudgetBakers provides a strong foundation, and these proposed enhancements can further improve usability, accessibility, and user satisfaction while maintaining the application's core functionality.